A Night in Darla's Bridge

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Glimmer (mentioned)

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set during s5, Hurt/Comfort, POV Catra (She-Ra), Protective Adora (She-Ra), Catra has PTSD - Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder (She-Ra), Nightmares, sleepover, Implied Sexual Content

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A Night in Darla's Bridge

by AuthorWithoutaName

Summary

Catra finds Adora sleeping in Darla's Bridge.

Notes

Alright, this is a quick one-shot for a weekly prompt: sleepover.

I am not completely happy with this piece to be honest, but I feel like I am in a slump right now, so if I don't post it now, I might not ever post it. Hopefully whoever reads this likes it!

Also, this did not have a beta reader, so apologizes in advance for any errors! I want to say that I wrote this in a day.

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra stalked down the hall. It was dark. It was quiet. She could hear the faint sounds of snores as she approached the door of one of Darla's cargo rooms. She stopped, her fist raised to give the door a light knock.

Her ear flickered. Her tail twitched a bit behind her. She moved her fist forward, just inches away from making contact with the door… Her hand unclenched and her arm fell to her side. Her ears flatten themselves against her head. She sighed and took a step away from the door and continued her walk down Darla's halls.

It was stupid. This whole night had been stupid. After spending hours lying on her cot, after doing her best to *clear her mind* as Bow put it, she had *finally* fallen asleep… Just spend a couple of hours trapped in horrible nightmares…

…Actually…

Were they still called nightmares if they were memories? Her time abroad the Velvet Glove haunted her. The few seconds she spent in the green pool replayed itself over and over and over again in her mind. It didn't matter if she was awake or asleep…

It was slightly easier to push the memory aside when she was awake. It didn't completely go away; the few moments where Adora wasn't by her side was when the memory haunted her waking moments. She knew that Adora knew that *something* was bothering her. She was fairly confident that Adora just didn't know what… At least not yet.

More than once Adora had offered her a chance to talk about it. A chance to let everything that had been building up since her rescue out… And everytime she refused. She didn't talk about it. She just needed to not think about it. She didn't want to Prime the satisfaction of being in her head constantly…

Despite her annoyance at Adora's insistence that talking would help her feel better, help her heal (as Glimmer put it), she still found herself wanting to be near the blonde at all times. She was

hoping to talk to the blonde just not actually… But not about Prime. Not about the Velvet Glove. And certainly not about the Fright Zone. Or Etheria. Or… Or… What was she wanting to talk to Adora about? She wasn't even sure… All she knew was that she just wanted to be around her right now… That her presence helped to calm her. It helped to keep the scary thoughts and memories away.

She began to walk past the threshold leading to the bridge. She stopped, giving the room a quick glance. There was a bit more light in there. There were windows, so she could just hang out in there; *watch space*… Maybe just sitting around for a bit and watching the stars would be nice.

She stepped into the bridge and made her way to the front console. As she stepped past the commander's chair though, something caught her eye…

"Adora?" Catra asked, glancing at the curled up form on the ground just before the chair.

The blonde had a blue blanket wrapped around herself. Somehow she had managed to curl up her almost six foot frame into something small enough that the commander's chair had hidden her from view until now.

A small smile pulled at Catra's lips as she stared at Adora's sleeping form. Her ears twitched as she heard the blonde murmur *something* in her sleep. Catra couldn't make out the words though. She knelt down, reaching out to gently prod Adora awake.

Adora stirred but didn't wake up. A soft chuckle escaped Catra as she began to shake her a little harder now.

"Adora… Adora…" She whispered, trying to keep her voice low in case Glimmer or Bow happened to wake up and walk by. Adora groaned. An arm snaked out of the blanket and tried to wave

Catra away. Catra removed her hand from the blonde's shoulder and watched her in amusement.

"...Five more… minutes…" Adora murmured sleepily. She yawned immediately after and pulled the blanket over her head. It was so short that pulling that much left her feet uncovered now.

"Listen… You picked the *worst* spot to sleep. You're gonna mess your back up. Just get up and go back to your room," Catra chided dryly.

Or you could ask to go to my room, she thought. Adora had asked her a couple of times if she could feel better, feel safer if they slept in the same room. Every time she asked, she offered to take the floor, giving Catra the small cot to herself. At first it annoyed her and she refused time and time again.

They spent years away from each other, how could Adora just *expect* her to be so willing to share a space with her again? Plus, she needed her distance. She needed some moments away from the… *Best Friend Squad* (still, a stupid, stupid name… Good job, Arrow Boy…)...

After spending a few days…? Catra realized that she wasn't sure how long she had been on Darla now. Was it a week? Or maybe *weeks*?

Anyway!

Adora stopped asking… Just when Catra had decided that she might actually say yes the next time Adora asked… But the blonde hadn't asked in a while and there was no way Catra was going to ask… no way at all…

Adora groaned again, pulling Catra out of her thoughts. She stirred again and then made a move to sit up. Out of instinct, Catra attempted to guide her. Her hands reached out to grab her by her shoulders– She realized what she was doing and stopped, lowering her arms back down to her sides.

She was still kneeling beside Adora. The blanket was now on the blonde's shoulders, almost like a cape. She yawned again, blinking the sleep out of her eyes. For a moment, Catra wasn't sure if Adora even registered that she was in the bridge with her. She recognized that hazy, tired look in Adora's eyes. It was the haze that alwa– *used* to accompany Adora's gaze whenever she had overdone it during training or whenever she didn't get enough sleep at night.

"So… Why are you sleeping in the bridge?" Catra asked, a trace of amusement in her voice.

Adora rubbed her eyes. She didn't startle, Catra assumed then that the blonde actually was aware that she was here then.

"Bow and Glimmer started…" Adora began to answer, she paused. Her face turned red as if she had just realized what she began to say. She continued sheepishly, "Um… You know what… Never mind. I figured it would be easier to sleep out here."

"Okay… gross…" Catra mused. Her tail flickered behind her. Honestly, she didn't think that Sparkles and Arrow Boy had it in them. She was actually kind of impressed.

"Wait! No! Not like– They were just making out," Adora said hurriedly, finally realizing just what she had said.

"Oh! Okay… *That* actually makes *a lot* more sense."

"Yeah… I just… thought they *might* like some privacy, so I left…"

You could have knocked on my door… Catra almost said out loud. She didn't voice that thought though. She supposed that Adora was just trying to give her space… She basically demanded for Adora to give her space a few days ago… But… Still…

There was *no way* she would offer her room. Adora could ask… She wouldn't be the first one to make a move. Adora was the one who left. Adora was the one who needed to come crawling back. That was only fair…

"So… What are you doing out here?" Adora asked her suddenly.

Catra's ears flattened against her mane– her head… Her mane didn't exist anymore…

…One good thing in her life…

She did that one good thing and what she got in return was an unwanted haircut, memories that haunted her every moment, and a scar on the back of her neck. Instinctively, she reached back at the scar on her neck. Her fingers carefully grazed the spot… She shuddered and brought her hand back down.

Adora was staring at her, concern evident in her blue eyes. Okay. Maybe she got a bit more after doing that *one good thing*. Maybe it was worth it. She did save Adora.

"Anyway," Adora said with a yawn, she lifted her arms high above her head and stretched.

…*Great*… Catra just realized that she got so lost in thought that she completely ignored Adora's question. She wasn't even sure how to answer that question. What should she tell her?

I'm just wandering this stupid space ship because memories of getting chipped just keep replaying over and over and over *again… Thought about going to your room and waking you up…*

Her tail was now thrashing behind her. Adora brought her arms back down after a moment and continued, "Do you… Do you wanna watch the stars… or… something?"

Her tail stopped. Her ears went back up. She glanced at Adora, blinking in confusion.

"What?"
"The stars. We're both up. We could just hang out and watch the stars for a bit," Adora said. Her voice had held a familiar softness. A softness that she always had whenever Catra was going through something back at the Fright Zone.

"Um… Sure…?" Mentally Catra cringed. She didn't mean for it to come out as a question. Hopefully Adora didn't notice. Adora smiled at her and then got to her feet, holding a hand out to help Catra up as well. She stared at it for a moment. She glanced up at Adora and for a brief moment, she didn't see Adora: Rebellion Hero… It was like time moved back, and instead of her former enemy holding her hand for her, it was her friend…

Her mind drifted back to their training at the Horde. The Adora of today flickered away and instead the Adora she grew up with stood before her. Time after time, after their spars, Adora would reach out and offer her hand to help her back to her feet.

Catra took the hand and allowed herself to be pulled to her feet. The Adora of the past flickered away, replaced once more by the Adora of today. Her blue eyes looked more weary now. The circles under them were darker and more prominent than before…

Adora released Catra's hand and began to walk to the main console. Catra followed. She stood beside Adora, glancing at her. She still had that *stupid* ponytail in. Of course she had it in. She always did. Even in the Horde, she would often fall asleep with it in. If it wasn't for her, Catra was sure that Adora would've started to go bald by now.

She fought the urge to go ahead and take the hair tie out. Instead, she chose to focus on something else. She followed Adora's gaze and stared out at the endless sea of stars before them.

"So… Everything… Everything okay?" Adora asked. Out of the corner of her eye, Catra saw her glance at her.

"Yeah. I'm fine… Just…" Out of habit, she reached back at the scar on her neck. She took a deep breath…

Exhale…

Her eyes closed for a moment… She rubbed the spot, she flinched. Adora reached over, her fingers wrapped around Catra's

wrist and she gently brought Catra's hand away from the scar and back down. She didn't release Catra's wrist though. Not yet at least…
"Listen, you don't have to talk about it," Adora said, offering her a small sympathetic smile. She released Catra's wrist. Catra frowned. Her ears flattened themselves against her head. Even if they weren't outright holding hands… She kind of liked having Adora holding her wrist. She could have adjusted her grip so they were holding hands instead…

Adora yawned, which prompted Catra to take a closer look at her face… She looked utterly *exhausted*… She sighed… Adora clearly didn't want to go back to her room. Maybe she should–

"You wanna just hang out in the bridge tonight?" Adora's voice pulled her out of her thoughts.

Before she could answer, Adora had already stepped back from the console and was walking back to the command chair. She knelt down beside the blanket, plucked it up off the floor and straightened it out.

"We don't have to talk about it, if you don't want to," she repeated, and patted the floor beside her.

Catra walked over to her and sat down across from her.

"We can just–" she yawned again, louder this time, "hang out… Watch the–" Another yawn, "stars… space…"

"On the floor?" Catra asked, raising an eyebrow at her.

"I mean, yeah…?" Adora looked at her like it was the most ridiculous question in space.

Catra took a moment to mentally weigh her options. She could just go back to room. She could lay back down on her cot, stare up at her ceiling for the rest of the night… Or she could stay in the bridge and spend the night watching the stars with Adora– Who yawned once again… Adora would probably fall asleep but

maybe just hanging around her would ease her mind a bit… Maybe…

"Yeah… okay," Catra huffed, giving the blonde a shrug. Adora smiled brightly and Catra scooted closer to her. Adora looked at her quizzically but didn't say anything. Instead she placed the blanket on Catra's shoulders.

"You looked cold," she offered, in answer to Catra's perplexed gaze.
"Thanks," Catra said, glancing now at the ground to avoid Adora's eyes. In her peripheral vision, she saw Adora glance back up at the large window in front of them. She was staring at the stars now. Catra looked up again, but she didn't watch the stars. Her mismatched gaze was on the blonde next to her.

***

Bow yawned as he entered Darla's bridge. It was hard to know the difference between *day* and *night* on Darla. It was dark outside… But it was always dark outside. It was space after all…

He stretched his arms high over his shoulder as he walked in, slowly making his way to the center console. He stopped just past the commander's chair, his eyes widening. Adora and Catra were fast asleep on the floor. A small blanket covering both of them. Catra's tail was on top of the blanket, draped across Adora's frame. Adora didn't have her signature ponytail. Bow caught sight of the always present hair tie wrapped around Catra's wrist that was poking out of the blanket.

They were sleeping soundly. Adora snores were almost drowned out by Catra's purrs.

His eyes almost lit up in actual sparkles and he fought himself to not squeal…

So cute!

End Notes

The Bow and Glimmer making out thing was inspired by Annacharlier's "Don't Go" fic xD

Kudos and comments are greatly appreciated!! To anyone that leaves kudos or comments: thank you!!! I try to reply to every comment, sometimes it takes me about a week though xD

Thank you so much for reading!!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!